forces to see that only their heads roll when things go out of control or mistakes happen, while the terrorists walk away with impunity even after committing heinous crimes. At times, not a word is spoken by the traumatized people, the media and the human rights organizations against the atrocities of terrorists. For example, when the media or the intelligentsia call such criminals who live by the gun culture and spread 'dahshat '(terror) as militants instead of terrorists, it is indeed sad and ironic! Some do so in order to be able to buy their peace and a safe passage in the disturbed areas. What an enormous price we pay for such compromises! It has rightly been said by counterinsurgency expert Paul Wilkinson that 'fighting terrorism is like being a goalkeeper. You can make a hundred brilliant saves but the only shot that people remember is the one that gets past you.'[2]

Important factors discussed heretofore and which should be kept in mind while planning and executing a counterinsurgency/terrorism campaign are summarized in Appendix 5.

Countering Terror in J&K

In J&K, we were able to achieve satisfying results in counterterrorism operations and against the ongoing proxy war. 'Our attrition ratios increased from 1:4 to 1:7 in our favour during 2005–07, which was a quantum jump. This is a simple yardstick that conveys who is getting the better of whom in tactical-level encounters or engagements. Simultaneously, there has been a perceptible drop in the levels of violence in the state. Elections have been conducted peacefully despite the usual threats from the jehadis, and there is an overall yearning for peace. The tide has successfully turned in our favour, which is evident from the increased level of intelligence forthcoming from the locals, and the spurt in the number of surrenders.'[3]

But this was anathema to the terrorists and their mentors across the border. In the summer of 2010, large processions became the